

PEAK PROPERTY PERFORMANCE® · OWNER'S FIELD GUIDE

Five Questions Every Owner Should Ask About Building Data.

*A short field guide for CRE owners and operators —
adapted from Peak Property Performance® (Fast
Company Press), Chapter 1.*

Most owners aren't failing. They're flying blind.

Your buildings already generate a wealth of data. The OT (operational technology) systems running them — HVAC, lighting, access control, video, metering, BMS, life safety — produce that data continuously. The problem isn't generation. The problem is that most of it is trapped: in dashboards you can view but can't export, in vendor portals you can log into but don't admin, in OT systems your property managers don't fully control.

That isn't a tech problem. It's a governance problem at the data & digital infrastructure layer those OT systems sit on. And it has a name.

"If you don't own your data & digital infrastructure, your vendors do — and your building's intelligence becomes someone else's asset."

WHAT THIS GUIDE IS FOR

The five questions on the pages that follow are not a checklist for evaluating individual products. They are stress-tests for the layer beneath the products — the data & digital infrastructure that determines whether the OT systems you already own actually compound or quietly leak. They will take longer to answer honestly than they will to ask.

Use them on your next vendor call. Use them on your next standing call with your PM. Use them in your next CapEx review. They are the same questions OpticWise asks owners during a Data & Digital Infrastructure (DDI) Review, also known as a Peak Property Performance® Review.

HOW THE QUESTIONS MAP TO THE PPP 5C™ PLAN

Each question lives somewhere in the PPP 5C™ Plan: **Clarify** • **Connect** • **Collect** • **Coordinate** • **Control**. We've labeled the mapping at the bottom of each page so you can see which phase each question is helping you stress-test.

"Own your data & digital infrastructure. Operate with strategic foresight. Build for the long game."

01

QUESTION ONE · PURPOSE

What are you actually trying to accomplish with each OT system in this building?

Every OT system in your building — HVAC, lighting, access, video, metering, BMS — was put in to do something. The question is whether anyone can still tell you what, and whether the data those systems generate is reaching the owner under owner rules.

WHY THIS MATTERS

"Smart" lighting. "Smart" thermostats. "Smart" access control. Each OT system was sold to your team with a promise — but the value of that promise depends on the layer beneath it. Property managers turn over. Vendors get acquired. Features ship. Capabilities sit dormant. The question isn't whether the OT system is on. It's whether the data & digital infrastructure it sits on is letting that system serve a real owner outcome.

GREEN FLAGS

- The OT system is tied to a named owner outcome (NOI, retention, OpEx, downtime).
- Someone on your team can explain what changes if it's turned off tomorrow.
- Outputs are reviewed on a regular cadence — not just when something breaks.

RED FLAGS

- "It came with the building." "We've always had it." No one owns the use case.
- The OT system has more capability than you're using, and no one has looked in years.
- Reports go to an inbox no one reads.

A MOVE YOU CAN MAKE THIS WEEK

Pick one OT system in one building. In one sentence, write down the owner outcome it's supposed to drive — and where its data is supposed to land for the owner. If you can't, you've found a candidate for either a use-case reset or a quiet retirement.

Are your OT systems actually **meeting** your requirements — or just running?

"It's working" is not the same as "it's earning its keep." Most owners discover real money the moment they stop confirming OT systems are on and start asking whether the data they generate is reaching the owner — under owner rules.

WHY THIS MATTERS

A building management system that only confirms the HVAC is running is a thermostat with a service contract. The same OT system, governed properly at the data & digital infrastructure layer and integrated with occupancy and weather data the owner controls, can change how you operate the asset. Most of the OT systems you're already paying for can do considerably more than they're doing today — but only if someone is governing the standard those systems plug into. That standard is the data & digital infrastructure layer. Without it, every system is its own island.

GREEN FLAGS

- You can name three specific things the OT system does for the property.
- Capabilities have been turned on and tuned in the last 12 months.
- The OT system talks to other OT systems through an owner-controlled data & digital infrastructure layer — under your rules, not the vendor's.

RED FLAGS

- The OT system was installed and never operationalized.
- "Advanced features" require a vendor visit and another change order.
- Each OT system runs on its own vendor network — there is no owner-controlled backplane underneath them.

A MOVE YOU CAN MAKE THIS WEEK

For one OT system in one building, ask: "What changed last quarter because of what this system told *us* — at the owner level?" If nothing changed, the issue isn't the system itself. It's that the data & digital infrastructure beneath it isn't getting that data to anyone who can act.

Is each contract still aligned with your goals, requirements, and budget?

Vendor contracts age in your favor only if you read them. Most owners discover, when they finally do, that they have been quietly paying for things they no longer use, on terms that no longer fit.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Contracts that started as a fair trade become structural OpEx leakage. Auto-renewals roll forward. Escalations compound. Service tiers stay the same long after your portfolio has changed. None of this is hidden — it's just rarely audited from the owner's seat.

GREEN FLAGS

- Contracts are reviewed at renewal against current portfolio reality.
- Pricing escalators, term length, and exit clauses are visible at the owner level.
- Required outcomes — including data export and admin credentials — are written in.

RED FLAGS

- You can't quickly produce the master list of vendor contracts touching the property.
- Auto-renewals have rolled multiple times without review.
- Steep price escalations after the initial term — and you're past the initial term.

A MOVE YOU CAN MAKE THIS WEEK

Pull the next three contracts coming up for renewal. Add three required clauses to your standard: data export rights, admin credentials, and portability of any captured data. These three lines change the power dynamic.

Do you actually **own and control** the data your systems generate?

When you ask a vendor, "Do we own our data?", the answer is almost always yes. The follow-up question is the one that matters.

WHY THIS MATTERS

Owning data and controlling data are not the same thing. Vendors will agree you "own" your data while the practical reality is that you can view it but not export it, log in but not admin it, see this month but not last year. If your data isn't extractable, analyzable, and portable to another platform, you don't own it — you rent access to it. That distinction shapes valuation, diligence, switching costs, and your AI options.

GREEN FLAGS

- You can export your data — historical and live — without a vendor's permission.
- Admin credentials live with the owner, not exclusively with the vendor.
- Data is normalized into a consistent model you can reuse across the portfolio.

RED FLAGS

- "Yes, you own it — but the export is in a proprietary format."
- Switching vendors means starting your data history over.
- Bidirectional data flow isn't allowed — you can read, but you can't write back.

A MOVE YOU CAN MAKE THIS WEEK

For one building, request a full historical data export from one vendor — in a format you can open and reuse. The speed and cooperativeness of that response will tell you exactly who is in control today.

Whose privacy and security standards govern your OT systems — yours, or each vendor's?

Privacy and security live or die at the data & digital infrastructure layer beneath your OT systems. They're no longer compliance checkboxes — they're part of how the asset is valued, leased, and underwritten.

WHY THIS MATTERS

The owner's standard has to sit higher than any single OT vendor's — the owner is the one carrying the asset, the brand, the leases, and the diligence story. A clean posture across your data & digital infrastructure (not per-system, but at the owner-controlled layer they all plug into) is one of the most under-told NOI stories: it lowers risk premiums, strengthens the insurance narrative, and signals to tenants the building is run by adults.

GREEN FLAGS

- Network segmentation, identity, and access are governed at the owner level.
- You collect operational data, not personally identifiable tenant data.
- Privacy posture is something you can confidently put in front of tenants.

RED FLAGS

- Each OT vendor brings its own network. There is no owner-controlled data & digital infrastructure backplane beneath them.
- No clear answer to who administers what when an OT system goes down at 2 a.m.
- Tenant-facing OT systems (access, video, networks) collect more personal data than the property actually needs.

A MOVE YOU CAN MAKE THIS WEEK

Ask one question across one building: "If an OT system goes down right now, who has admin credentials at the owner level?" If the honest answer is "the vendor," you've found one of the highest-leverage governance gaps in your data & digital infrastructure.

From five questions to a one-building plan.

If you ran these five questions across one of your properties this week, you would almost certainly find one of three patterns:

1. **Shelfware.** An OT system you're paying for that was never fully operationalized after a PM change.
2. **Redundant rails.** Multiple OT networks or systems doing the same job, paid for twice in CapEx and OpEx — because there's no owner-controlled data & digital infrastructure underneath them.
3. **Vendor-controlled data.** Data you "own" in name only — visible, but not portable, and not yours to act on with the tools of your choice.

None of these patterns are solved by replacing technology or shopping for new systems. They are solved by taking back the layer beneath the systems — the data & digital infrastructure that determines whether the OT you already have compounds value or quietly leaks it. That is the work of the PPP 5C™ Plan, and it is what OpticWise does with owners every day. We are not a PropTech vendor. We do not sell you a new system. We make the systems you already have answer to you.

"If you own your data & digital infrastructure, switching vendors is not that difficult."

RECOMMENDED NEXT STEP

Book a Data & Digital Infrastructure (DDI) Review

One building. One conversation. We map who owns what, where data is leaking, and where operational burden is stacking up against your KPIs — and we hand you a plan you can act on whether you ever work with us or not.

BOOK YOUR DDI REVIEW →

data-digital-cre-review.opticwise.com

*Own your data & digital infrastructure.
Operate with strategic foresight. Build for the long game.*